

Information Technology



■ Riding the IT wave

Tamilnadu, with its vast pool of highly educated manpower and industry-friendly environments has always been a favourite destination for IT majors. The state is now gearing up for a fierce competition with its neighbours to grab the lion's share of the IT pie. With a massive focus on IT infrastructure, the state of Tamilnadu is set to garner substantial revenue of Rs 28,000 crore from software exports in the Financial Year 2008 - 09. Leveraging on the union government's express approval of IT SEZ projects, the state has so far received approvals for 37 such projects spread over an extent of 1226.32 hectares. Out of these, 19 have been notified and have commenced their operations. One multi service SEZ, covering an extent of 2,192.44 hectares has also been given formal approval in Tamilnadu. In addition, 6 Electronic Hardware, Software and related service SEZs covering an extent of 464.45 hectares have also got formal approval.

Apart from software majors, the state has laid out the welcome mat for IT hardware electronic giants as well. These include NOKIA, Foxcon, Flextronics and Motorola. Many of these companies have already moved in and some have even commenced operations. Won over by the states business friendly climate, many more IT giants like Dell computers, Samsung, ASPOCOMP, Spelmech semi-conductors, Salcomp, Perlos, Jabil, Wintek etc. have decided to make their presence felt in the state in a big way. So far, 464.45 hectares housing 6 electronic hardware, software and related service SEZs have been given formal approval.

■ Future plans around Chennai...

TIDCO (Tamilnadu Industrial Development Corporation), an undertaking of the government of Tamilnadu has formed a joint venture with M/S DLF Limited for putting up an IT-ITES SEZ with 4.5 million sq.ft. built up space on 26.64 acres of land at Taramani in Chennai. Another project aims to develop an IT-ITES Park with an Integrated International convention centre on 25.27 acres of land at Taramani in Chennai. It is also being executed by TIDCO. At Sholinganallur near Chennai, the IT-ITES SEZ developed by ELCOT (Electronics Corporation of Tamilnadu), a Government of Tamilnadu undertaking, has begun functioning.

ELCOT has already obtained formal permission to establish an IT-ITES SEZ at Perumbakkam-Sholinganallur villages near Chennai. ELCOT proposes to set up an integrated IT township on 213 acres of land.

■ Future plans for Coimbatore, Madurai and Trichy

A consortium, comprising ELCOT, TIDCO, TIDEL (joint venture between TIDCO and ELCOT) and STPI are jointly setting up an IT park on land covering an extent of 31.51 acres at Coimbatore. The foundation stone for this project was laid by the Hon'ble Chief Minister on 24th February 2007. ELCOT has established IT-ITES SEZ at Ilandaikulam, Madurai and at Vadapalanji village abutting the Madurai Kamaraj University. The Hon'ble Chief Minister laid the foundation stone for these two IT parks on 26th February 2008. An IT-ITES SEZ has been established at Tiruchirapalli in an area of 135.04 acres by ELCOT.

A foundation stone has been laid by the Hon'ble Chief Minister on 14th September 2007 for an IT park at Salem in an area of 164.26 acres. Considering the plethora of future IT projects coming up in the major cities of Tamilnadu, the state is well on its way to becoming the leading IT hub on the IT-ITES map of India.